

Vite Interview Questions and Answers

1. What is Vite?

Vite is a modern frontend build tool created by Evan You. It provides a faster development experience using native ES modules and on-demand compilation with Hot Module Replacement (HMR).

2. How is Vite different from Webpack?

Vite uses native ES modules and esbuild for pre-bundling which leads to faster builds. Webpack uses bundled files and has slower HMR and dev startup.

3. What are the main features of Vite?

- Lightning-fast cold start
- Hot Module Replacement (HMR)
- Native ESM support
- Pre-bundling with esbuild
- Optimized build using Rollup

4. What is the role of esbuild in Vite?

Vite uses esbuild for extremely fast pre-bundling of dependencies which makes the dev server start almost instantly.

5. What is HMR in Vite?

HMR (Hot Module Replacement) allows real-time updates of modules in the browser during development without full page reloads.

6. How does Vite improve development speed?

It uses native ESM, esbuild pre-bundling, on-demand compilation, and fast HMR without rebundling everything on every change.

7. How does Vite handle static assets like images and CSS?

Vite allows importing static files in JS/TS and processes them during build. They are copied to `dist` with unique hashed names.

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8. What does the vite.config.js file do?

This file configures plugins, server settings, path aliases, and build options.

9. How to use environment variables in Vite?

Use `.env` files with variables prefixed with `VITE_` to expose them to frontend code via `import.meta.env`.

10. What build tool does Vite use under the hood for production?

Vite uses Rollup internally for production builds to create optimized and bundled outputs.

11. Can you use Vite with React or Vue?

Yes. Vite provides official templates for both React and Vue using `npm create vite@latest`.

12. How does code splitting work in Vite?

Vite supports code splitting via dynamic imports (`import()`) using Rollup's built-in features.

13. How do Vite plugins work?

Vite plugins extend the functionality based on Rollup's plugin API with added support for development-time features like HMR.

14. What are some popular Vite plugins?

- `@vitejs/plugin-react`
- `vite-plugin-pwa`
- `vite-plugin-svgr`
- `vite-plugin-env-compatible`

15. How to deploy a Vite app?

Run `npm run build` to generate the `dist/` folder. Host it on Netlify, Vercel, GitHub Pages, Firebase, or your own static server.